

PAUL MICHEL

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Education

since 05/2023	University of Cologne
Ph.D. candidate Political Science	
10/2020 – 03/2023	University of Göttingen
M.Sc. Development Economics	
10/2019 – 09/2020	University of Leipzig
M.Sc. Economics	
04/2015 – 03/2019	University of Mainz
B.A. Political Science	
B.Sc. Economics	
Semester abroad: Nelson Mandela University, Port Elizabeth, South Africa	

Publications

“Cohesion Among Whom? Stayees, Displaced, and Returnees in Conflict Contexts” (with Tilman Brück, Sarah Langlotz, Patricia Justino, and Philip Verwimp), *Journal of Conflict Resolution* 69(1): 3–16.

Working Papers

“Collective Responsibility and Mass Preferences over Climate Action”.

“Not In My Basement: The Political Consequences of Climate Reforms” (with Michael M. Bechtel and Nils Blossy). *Under review*.

“Risk and Rescue: Irregular Migration Across Origin and Transit” (with Sarah Langlotz and Sebastian Leue).

“Most Europeans support significant climate investment over carbon revenue recycling” (with Michael M. Bechtel, Philipp Genschel, and Laura Seelkopf). *R&R at Nature Communications*.

Work Experience

since 05/2023	University of Cologne
Research Associate, Political Economy Lab (Prof. Michael Bechtel)	
10/2020 – 08/2022	University of Göttingen
Research Assistant, Chair of Development Economics (Prof. Andreas Fuchs)	
10/2019 – 09/2020	Fraunhofer
Research Assistant, Center for International Management and Knowledge Economy IMW, Leipzig, Germany	
06/2018 – 08/2018	Auswärtiges Amt (Federal Foreign Office)
Intern, German Embassy Nairobi, Kenya	

08/2017 – 12/2017

KfW Development Bank

Intern, Health and Social Security Asia, Frankfurt/Main, Germany

Research Affiliations

since 05/2023

ECONtribute Cluster of Excellence

Presentations

2023:

Annual Conference on Migration and Diversity, WZB Social Science Center, Berlin, Germany

2024:

Departmental Speaker Series, University of Cologne, Germany

EPSA Annual Conference, Cologne, Germany

APSA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, US

Joint Cologne-Zurich Retreat, Filzbach, Switzerland

GESIS Workshop on Earth Observation Data in the Social Sciences, Cologne, Germany

2025:

EPG Conference, Sachseln, Switzerland

Departmental Speaker Series, University of Cologne, Germany

EPSA Annual Conference, Madrid, Spain

ECONtribute Cluster Retreat, Mettmann, Germany

Workshop on the Politics and Irregular Migration, Hamburg, Germany (co-organizer with Sarah Langlotz and Sebastian Leue)

CEMIR Junior Economist Workshop on Migration Research, ifo, Munich, Germany

2026:

Joint Cologne-Zurich-Innsbruck Retreat, Jenbach, Austria

RF-Berlin Migration Forum, Berlin, Germany

International Conference on Migration and Development, Seoul, Republic of Korea

LSE Sustainable Social Policy Workshop, London, United Kingdom

Beyond Basic Questions Conference 2026, Marburg, Germany

Teaching

University of Cologne

Public Policy, tutorial, undergraduate

Voters, Public Opinion, and Policymaking, seminar, undergraduate

Research Logic and Research Design, seminar, undergraduate

The Politics of Migration, seminar, undergraduate

University of Mainz

Macroeconomics, tutorial, undergraduate

Microeconomics, exam preparation course, undergraduate

Empirical Economic Research, exam preparation course, undergraduate

Refereeing

British Journal of Political Science; Environmental Politics; European Journal of Political Research (2x); Journal of Elections, Public Opinion, and Parties; Political Behavior

Grants

2024:

C-SEB Junior StartUp Grant, Center for Social and Economic Behavior, University of Cologne (4,000 €)

Dr. Hans-Riegel-Foundation, Connex - Science Networking grant (with Sarah Langlotz and Sebastian Leue) (6,500 €)

2025:

C-SEB Junior StartUp Grant, Center for Social and Economic Behavior, University of Cologne (4,000 €)

Selten Seeding Grant, ECONtribute Cluster of Excellence, University of Cologne (5,000 €)

German Research Foundation (DFG), Grant for international scientific events (with Sarah Langlotz and Sebastian Leue), Workshop on “Economics and Politics of Irregular Migration” (4,500 €)

Service

Alternate Academic Staff Representative, Department Board, Department of Political Science, University of Cologne

Languages

German (native)

English (fluent)

French (intermediate)